What you need to know about:	Protest Songs and Poems	Big Picture
Key Concept	**Related Concepts**	**Global Context:**
Creativity	Purpose, Style, Context	Audience imperatives, Self-expression

Through creative self-expression, songwriters and poets can inspire their audiences to join protest movements that lead to a more fair and just society.

Protest Movement	Important Issues	Important Poems	Important Songs
Civil Rights	Racial inequality, segregation, justice, freedom, identity, dignity	*"Still I Rise"* – Maya Angelou *"Let America Be America Again"* – Langston Hughes	*"We Shall Overcome"* – Traditional *"A Change Is Gonna Come"* – Sam Cooke
Labor	Workers' rights, fair pay, safe conditions, solidarity, anti-exploitation	*"The Cry of the Children"* – Elizabeth Barrett Browning *"Bread and Roses"* – James Oppenheim	*"Which Side Are You On?"* – Florence Reece *"Solidarity Forever"* – Ralph Chaplin
Anti-War	Peace, human cost, nationalism, conscience, moral duty	*"Dulce et Decorum Est"* – Wilfred Owen *"Anthem for Doomed Youth"* – Wilfred Owen	*"Blowin' in the Wind"* – Bob Dylan *"Give Peace a Chance"* – John Lennon

Forms of Protest

Strike: mass refusal to work in order to get better conditions for workers	Petition: written request signed by many
Boycott: refusal to buy/use something to financially hurt company or organization	Sit-in: peaceful occupation of a place to get attention for an issue or to cause change
March: walking in group to get attention for movement	Demonstrations: large group gatherings to get attention or create movement

How to Talk About Poetry

Allusion	Reference to a famous person, event, or work of art that adds meaning.
Meter	The pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables that creates rhythm.
Motif	Repeated image, idea, or symbol that builds a theme throughout a text.
Onomatopoeia	A word that imitates a sound (for example boom, buzz, hiss).
Personification	Giving human qualities to non-human things
Repetition	Reusing words, phrases, or lines to emphasize an idea or create rhythm.
Rhyme Scheme	The pattern of rhyming words at the ends of lines (i.e, ABAB or AABB).
Stanza	A group of lines in a poem, like a paragraph in prose.
Tone	Author's attitude toward the subject (for example angry, hopeful, mournful).

How Art Leads to Action

Creates strong emotions in audience	Draws attention to injustice and suffering
Provides unity and group strength	Gives voice to those without power
Spreads message in easy to remember form	Provides inspiration and hope for future

How to Analyze Poems and Songs

Identify stylistic features → Explain their effect → Connect to purpose/theme.